Content

Open guidance

Creating an action plan

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> **Knowing is not enough; we must apply.**
> **Wishing is not enough; we must do..**
>
> *Johann Wolfgang von Goethe.*

To move from analysis to action, you need to ask: **What steps do we need to take to close the gap?**

This stage of a project focuses on how to implement the steps needed to move the business to the desired future state.

Case study: Microsoft focus on Cloud

Microsoft recognised that the future of business was moving increasingly towards digital solutions. The company identified a gap in its service offerings—it lagged behind in the booming cloud services sector, where competitors like Amazon (with AWS) were gaining a significant market share.



Microsoft staged a comprehensive strategic move towards becoming a leader in cloud computing with its Azure platform. This involved heavy investment in infrastructure, modification of software for cloud compatibility, and changing the business model to align with cloud services.

Essential components of an action plan

1. **Actions**: What steps need to be taken to make this new process a reality?
2. **Priority**: What are the importance and priority levels of these actions?
3. **Responsibility**: Who will own the delivery of this?
4. **Target date**: When does this need to be delivered?
5. **Monitor progress:** What is the current status of these actions?

An action plan for Flexi Yoga

The fishbone analysis revealed several gaps that need addressing. The action plan below lists the gaps along with their priority level, and a high-level plan for addressing them.

Gap	Action	Priority	Responsible	Target date	Status
What is the gap?	**What action needs to be taken?**	**What is the priority?**	**Who will own this action?**	**What is the deadline for this action?**	**What is the current status?**
Quality of virtual classes is low (clients cannot hear instructor and music)	Update the technology to provide higher-quality sound and video	High	Product team	31st Dec	In progress
Website does not allow	Build new website that	High	Product team	1st Jan	In progress

customers to book and join virtual classes	enables better user experience: clients can book online and join virtual classes				
Lack of understanding of customers' needs re virtual classes	Conduct market research to clarify needs of target audience	High	Marketing team	15th Dec	In progress

Download this template to help you create an action plan

Action Plan template.docx

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